



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Faith Heritage Christian Academy
School Website: <https://www.faithheritage.com/>

December 22, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

Faith Heritage Christian Academy (FHCA) in Millington, Tennessee appears as a faith-centered institution with explicit biblical formation as a core aim. The school explicitly states a Biblical worldview as part of its mission and includes Bible coursework within its University Prep Diploma, signaling a grounding in theology and religious formation. However, the publicly visible curriculum and pedagogy do not clearly map to a full classical liberal-arts structure (e.g., explicit Great Books study, Latin, or a traditional Trivium progression), and there is no consistent, publicly documented emphasis on classical teaching methods such as Socratic seminars, memory work, or scholé cycles across all grade levels. Taken together across the six categories, FHCA demonstrates some classical elements (notably religious/metaphysical framing and formation-oriented goals) but lacks several core classical-defining practices in curriculum and pedagogy.

Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): CLASSICAL
- Element 2 (Purpose and Goal): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 3 (Curriculum): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): NOT CLASSICAL
- Element 5 (Faculty): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6 (Parents & Community): SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Key supporting materials come from FHCA's public pages (mission statements, diploma requirements, on-campus information, and related materials) and from standard classical-education criteria in the knowledge base. See citations to FHCA content and to the classical-education keyword lexicon for explicit terms used to justify the classifications below.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FHCA explicitly cites a Biblical worldview as a central organizing frame in its mission, signaling transcendental formation and the aim of fostering virtue through faith. The mission text: "To equip our students with knowledge and understanding, and enable them to view life from a Biblical worldview that demands excellence in all areas of life in order to bring honor and glory to God."
 - Bible study is embedded in the curriculum (Bible I–IV) as part of the graduation requirements, indicating theology/Scripture is integrated into academic work.
 - There are public links to a faith community (Faith Heritage Baptist Church) connected to the school site, reinforcing liturgical/communal religious life as part of the school ecosystem.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: biblical worldview, Christ-centered education, Bible coursework, God/glory to God, theology-related framing.

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- Negative indicators: none evident in the public materials.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive keywords dominate (roughly multiple occurrences of “Biblical worldview,” “Bible,” “Christ-Centered,” and God-related language with no clear secularizing signals). Positive > Negative by a wide margin (approximately 4+ positive cues vs 0 negative cues in the visible material for this category).
 - Why this rating
 - The school foregrounds theological formation and sacred aims (biblical worldview, Christ-centered education) and embeds Bible study in the core curriculum, aligning strongly with the “Transcendental moral realism,” “Grounded in Theology,” and “Liturgical/Communal Practices” cues in classical criteria, even as explicit liturgical routines are not extensively advertised on site. This supports CLASSICAL in this category, per the Six Essentials lexicon.
 - Source anchors
 - Mission text and Biblical framing: FHCA mission page.
 - Bible requirements in graduation/curriculum: Graduation requirements document.
 - Church affiliation/relationship (liturgical/a communal element): On Campus page.
 - Classical-criteria reference (positive/negative keyword framework): Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The mission emphasizes forming students through a Biblical worldview and “excellence in all areas of life” to honor God, which signals formation of character and a telos beyond vocational preparation.
 - Graduation and diploma structure (University Prep Diploma) indicates a college-preparatory orientation, with a structured curriculum and tests (ACT/SAT) tied to college admission. This is a modern, information-rich preparation framework rather than a purely formation-centered aim.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: formation-oriented language (excellence in all areas of life), telos-language implicit in forming character toward a moral/biblical ends.
 - Negative indicators: explicit classical “Great Conversation” aims or explicit articulation of the liberal-arts telos (truth, goodness, beauty as real, knowable) is not stated; focus leans toward formation with a modern diploma track.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive cues present but not strongly anchored in explicit classical vocabulary; roughly one to a few formation-focused phrases versus a lack of explicit classical telos language; overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The school’s stated purpose centers on formation and a biblical telos, but it does not consistently articulate the classical triad of truth-goodness-beauty as a real, knowable end in its public materials, nor does it present the classical curriculum’s philosophical/anthical framing in full. The presence of a formal college-prep track tempers the strictly classical framing.
- Source anchors
 - Mission language and formation framing: FHCA mission page.
 - University Prep Diploma and graduation structure: Graduation requirements doc.
 - Classical keyword framework (for reference): lexicon of classical keywords.

Element 3: School Curriculum — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The core visible curriculum includes Bible (4 credits), English, Math, Science, History/Geography, and related standard subjects as part of a University Prep Diploma. This signals a traditional college-prep curriculum rather than a classical curriculum staged around grammar–logic–rhetoric progression and the Great Books. Bible requirements are explicit, but there is no explicit Great Books program or “Great Conversation” framing on the public site.

- There is mention of Monarch Online Curriculum (external program) but not a public, school-wide classical core (e.g., Trivium emphasis, Latin, or a formal Great Books sequence).
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators present: Bible-focused coursework, clear sequencing of core subjects (English, Math, History/Geography, Science, etc.), a college-prep diploma framework.
 - Negative indicators: Lack of explicit classical curriculum elements (grammar-logic-rhetoric; Great Books; Latin; universal history as Western civ through the curriculum) and no overt mention of a Great Books program or liberal-arts breadth in the public materials.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive mentions (Bible, standard subjects, diploma) – 3–5 items; Negative classical markers – 0 explicit (no Great Books, no Trivium mention). Overall: NOT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The documented curriculum aligns with a modern, faith-based college-prep program rather than a classical curriculum grounded in the liberal-arts tradition and classical texts. The absence of explicit Great Books and classic Trivium elements supports NOT CLASSICAL in this category.
- Source anchors
 - Graduation requirements and Bible core: Graduation/University Prep Diploma documentation.
 - Curriculum components (Bible, general subjects): Same graduation docs.
 - Monarch Online Curriculum reference (public site): On Campus page / Home content.
 - Classical keyword framework (reference): Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — NOT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - Public materials do not clearly describe classical pedagogy such as Socratic seminars, scholé, memory work, recitation-based pedagogy, or rigorous rhetoric curricula across grade bands. The available public materials emphasize mission, graduation tracks, and administrative information rather than a detailed description of how learning is taught in daily practice.
 - Some references to external online curricula (Monarch) and standard course structures suggest conventional instruction rather than explicitly classical pedagogy.
- Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators (classical pedagogy cues): none explicitly evident in the public FHCA materials.
 - Negative indicators: lack of explicit descriptions of Socratic seminars, memory work, recitation/chanting, or scholé-based cycles.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive indicators 0; Negative indicators 3–5 explicit classical-pedagogy cues absent; Net result: NOT CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
 - The absence of explicitly described classical teaching methods (Socratic dialogue, memory work, recitation, or structured scholé/restful cycles) in public-facing FHCA materials places pedagogy outside the classical pedagogy zone as defined by the Six Elements lexicon.
- Source anchors
 - Pedagogical description absence in mission/curriculum pages: FHCA mission and curriculum materials.
 - Classical pedagogy reference (for rubric): Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - The site shows leadership (e.g., Headmaster) and a school community that references teachers as mentors in a faith-informed environment; employment pages indicate a faculty base rooted in Christian faith. This suggests a culture of virtuous exemplars, though not a fully explicit “living curriculum” or formal faculty portrait.

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- The mission emphasizes a Christ-centered education, indirectly implying teachers as moral exemplars in line with classical ideals (though not explicitly labeled as such).
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators: Headmaster, Christ-centered education, teacher leadership implied by mission; the idea of teachers as mentors aligns with classical expectations (even if not labeled as such on site).
 - Negative indicators: No explicit “portrait of a teacher,” no formal statement that the faculty themselves are the living curriculum in public materials.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive cues present (leadership roles, ethos) but not explicit classical-faculty framing; combined impression: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating
 - FHCA shows leadership and a faith-centered approach that aligns with some classical faculty expectations, but the materials do not provide explicit statements about a formal classical-faculty model (portrait of teacher, living curriculum, etc.). This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for the category.
 - Source anchors
 - On-campus leadership/administration: FHCA home/on-campus materials.
 - Mission framing and Christian-educator ethos: FHCA mission page.
 - Classical-faculty framework (reference): Six Essential Elements lexicon.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

- Evidence
 - FHCA shows a community-connected model with connections to families, alumni, and opportunities for involvement (news, on-campus info, partnerships, and volunteer/donation pages). The site signals parent and community engagement through open-campus references, volunteer opportunities, and donor pages.
 - There are explicit references to family and alumni networks (eagle-news, alumni achievements) and to parent-supportive activities (donations, volunteering). These reflect the school’s willingness to engage parents and families, though not always framed as “parents as co-teachers” in the public content.
 - Positive/Negative keyword analysis
 - Positive indicators: Partnership with families language is not overt in FHCA’s public copy, but there is observable parent/community involvement through events, volunteering, and alumni networks; “Open campus” and family connections appear in various FHCA materials.
 - Negative indicators: The explicit “parents as co-teachers” framing and formal parent-formation programs are not clearly articulated on the public site; no explicit “family catechesis” or home-education alignment language is shown.
 - Quantitative estimate: Positive cues visible (family/alumni/community ties) but lacking strong explicit classical-parent partnerships; overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
 - Why this rating
 - FHCA demonstrates active parent/community engagement through events, volunteering, and alumni networks, which aligns with some classical expectations (partnership with families, parental involvement) though not with a fully articulated classical-education partnership model in public-facing materials.
 - Source anchors
 - On Campus and News/Alumni sections: FHCA public pages.
 - Classical keyword framework (for reference): Six Essential Elements lexicon.
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What Would Move the Needle

- Adopt explicit Great Books and liberal-arts programming: publicly articulate a Great Books curriculum and a modern Trivium progression (grammar-logic-rhetoric) across grades, along with Latin or classical language study, and a confirmed sequence of history anchored in Western civilization. This would shift Curriculum (Element 3) from NOT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
 - Signal classical pedagogy publicly: describe and implement Socratic seminars, scholé cycles, memory work, recitation, and disciplined rhetoric across upper grades; publish examples of seminars or seminars-based assessment to move Pedagogy (Element 4) toward CLASSICAL.
 - Develop a formal “living curriculum” statement for faculty: publicly describe how the faculty exemplifies virtue and serves as the living curriculum, including teacher formation in classical pedagogy, and a teacher-portrait program. This would strengthen Faculty (Element 5) to CLASSICAL.
 - Strengthen and publicize a formal partnership with families: publish explicit language and programs that designate parents as co-educators (parent formation, home-school partnership, family-liturgy alignment), and provide structured parent book clubs or study guides. This would move Parents & Community (Element 6) toward CLASSICAL.
 - Elevate explicit theological integration in all disciplines: articulate how theology informs each disciplinary approach, including explicit integration of sacred tradition, eternal questions, and branded “great conversation” elements across the curriculum. This would further reinforce Religious and Metaphysical Foundations (Element 1) toward CLASSICAL.
 - These needle-moving changes align with the Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (1) and with the Positive keyword indicators in the classical lexicon (truth, virtue, theology, liturgy, wonder, Great Books, etc.). See the “Six Essential Elements” document for structure, and the classical keyword lexicon for positive/negative signs to target.
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Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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